

FOR CREATIVE STRATEGISTS

A seven-step Meta Ad Library scan.

Twenty minutes on a Sunday for a mental model most strategists never build.

07



@csos

Swipe →

STEP 1. FILTER AND SORT

Filter the Ad Library by the last ninety days and sort by start date.

The ads running right now are the ads worth reading, because the dead ones will only tell you what stopped working months ago.

Specifically do look for: ads that started recently and have stayed live.

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STEP 2. AGE OF THE AD

An ad that has been live for more than sixty days is almost certainly working, because the brand would have killed it otherwise.

Write those brand names down on one page before you do anything else.

Specifically do look for: start date older than sixty days on a still-live ad.

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STEP 3. HOOK FORMAT, NOT HOOK WORDS

DO NOT COPY

The exact first line of a winning ad, word for word, into your own ad.

DO COPY

The format of the hook, such as a talking head, a before and after shot, or text laid over a stat. Name the format on the page.

STEP 4. REPETITION ACROSS THEIR TOP FIVE

Read the top five live ads inside the same brand and look for the pattern that repeats across them.

If four of the five open on a face on camera, that is the format winning for the brand right now, and you are reverse-engineering a research finding rather than a single script.

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STEP 5. THE ANGLE UNDER THE HOOK

Pull the angle that sits underneath the hook. The hook is the delivery, and the angle is the actual argument the ad is making about the product and the buyer.

Write that argument down in one sentence, on the same page as the brand name.

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STEP 6. THE OFFER, NOT THE WORDS

Read what the offer is actually doing, not how the offer is worded.

A trial, a bundle, a one-time price, or a subscription with a floor will each move an ad more than any hook would on its own.

Write the offer down beside the angle on the page.

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STEP 7. WHAT IS MISSING

Read across every winning ad and ask what is missing from all of them combined.

The angle nobody in the category is running, the channel nobody is trying, the promise nobody is making.

That gap is where your own ad goes.

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NEXT STEP

Want to see where you stand as a creative strategist?

Take the 3-minute creative strategy quiz.

→ adscreativestrategy.com/quiz